

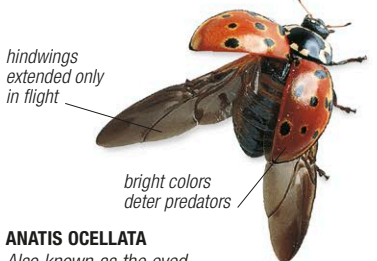
Family Coccinellidae

Ladybugs

Occurrence 5,000 spp. worldwide; almost anywhere on foliage where insect prey is present



Also called lady beetles or ladybirds, these short-legged beetles are brightly colored, often with spots or stripes. They are $\frac{1}{32}$ – $\frac{1}{2}$ in (1–15 mm) long, rounded and convex, with the pronotum often hiding the head. They are either shiny and smooth, or hairy. Antennae are segmented, with a short, terminal club. Eggs are glued singly or in small groups to plants. Although some species are herbivorous, most adults and larvae are predators of soft-bodied insects. This makes them useful as controlling agents of pests.



ANATIS OCELLATA
Also known as the eyed ladybird, this unmistakable large European species feeds on jumping plant lice and other small prey.

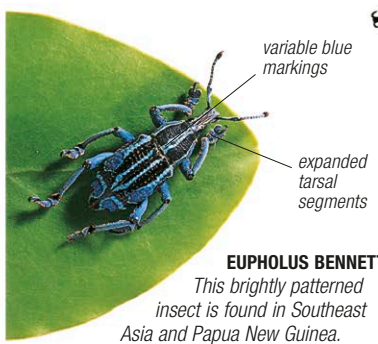
Family Curculionidae

Weevils

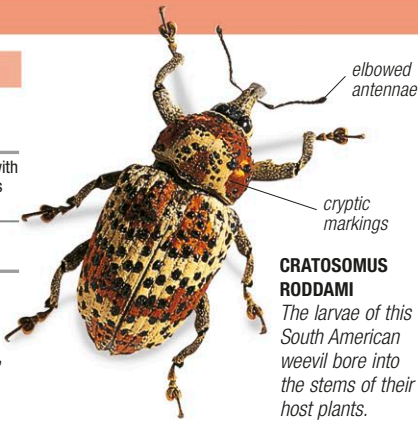
Occurrence 50–55,000 spp. worldwide; associated with almost every terrestrial and some aquatic plant species

Habitat Terrestrial

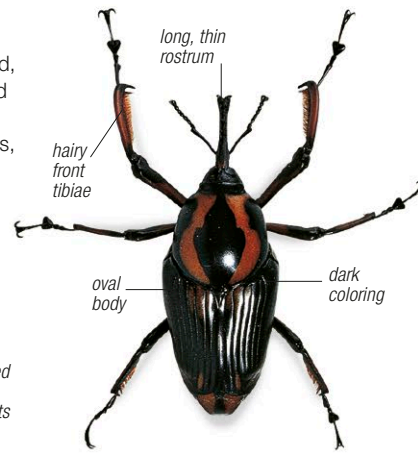
Weevils, also known as snout beetles, form one of the largest families in the animal kingdom. Most have a rostrum, which is an extension of the head and carries the mouthparts. The body is $\frac{1}{32}$ – $3\frac{1}{2}$ in (0.1–9 cm) long, and may be cryptically or brightly colored, with patterns and metallic scales. The antennae are usually 11-segmented, and are elbowed or bent. Eggs are laid inside plant tissue or in soil. Mostly diurnal, adults chew and eat soft plants, while larvae mostly feed inside plant tissue. Many weevils are crop pests.



EUPHOLUS BENNETTI
This brightly patterned insect is found in Southeast Asia and Papua New Guinea.



CRATOSOMUS RODDAMI
The larvae of this South American weevil bore into the stems of their host plants.



CYRTOTRACHELUS SP.
The males of this Southeast Asian genus have long, hairy front tibiae, used in courtship displays.

Family Dermestidae

Larder beetles

Occurrence 950 spp. worldwide; mostly associated with dried animal remains



Many species of larder beetles are serious pests of food or animal matter stored in buildings; larvae scavenge on dried meat or fish, and on plant material, woollens, silks, or furs. These beetles are either rounded or slightly elongated, and measure $\frac{1}{16}$ – $\frac{3}{8}$ in (2–12 mm) in length. Dull brown or black, they are usually covered with patterns of colored hairs or scales. Females lay up to 150 eggs, in about 2 weeks, on foodstuffs. The hairy larvae feed at a great rate and, in hot countries, mature in a few weeks. The adults feed on pollen and nectar. These beetles are also called skin or museum beetles.

DERMESTES LARDARIUS
Found worldwide, this species inhabits bird nests, warehouses, dry corpses, and animal matter. It feeds on dried meat and cheese in houses.



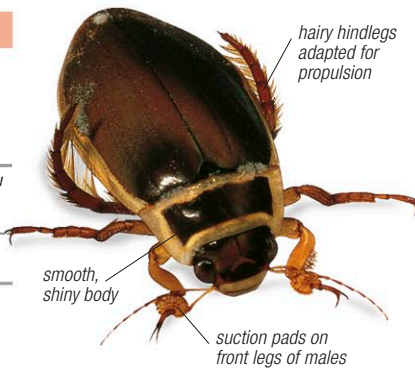
Family Dytiscidae

Predacious diving beetles

Occurrence 3,500 spp. worldwide; in streams, shallow lakes and ponds, brackish pools, thermal springs



These beetles are $\frac{1}{16}$ –2 in (0.2–5 cm) long, oval, and mostly black or dark brown. They are fierce predators that attack everything from other insects to mollusks or vertebrates. Larvae are called water tigers. Well adapted to aquatic life, the adults can carry air supplies beneath their wing cases.



DYTISCUS MARGINALIS
The great diving beetle inhabits ponds and shallow lakes in Europe and Asia. The male has suction pads on its front legs for holding onto the female during mating.

Family Elateridae

Click beetles

Occurrence 9,000 spp. worldwide; around plants, in leaf litter, rotten wood, soil



Click beetles, also called skip jacks, are able to propel themselves into the air, making a loud “click” that frightens predators. Their rapid jump is made possible by powerful thoracic muscles and a unique “peg-and-joint” catch mechanism on the underside of the thorax. They are dull in color,

elongated to oval, and parallel-sided, tapering at the rear. Body length ranges from $\frac{1}{16}$ – $2\frac{3}{4}$ in (0.2 to 7 cm). Eggs are laid in soil and plant matter. The larvae, called wireworms, are generally predatory, although some feed on plant roots and tubers.



CHALCOLEPIDIUS LIMBATUS
Found in South America, this species eats plants as well as insects. Larvae develop in soil, litter, or rotting wood.

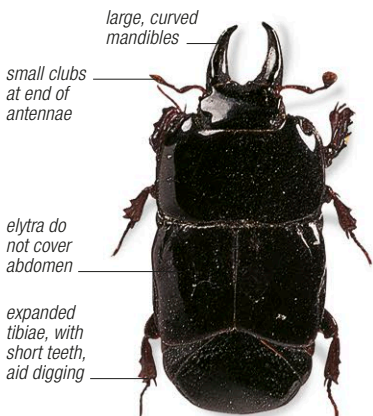
Family Histeridae

Hister beetles

Occurrence 3,000 spp. worldwide; in dung, carrion, under bark, in tunnels of wood-boring insects, ant nests



These tough-bodied beetles have a rounded or oval outline; some species may be flattened. Most species are black or metallic, and have striations on the elytra and other body parts. They are mostly less than $\frac{1}{2}$ in (1.5 cm) in length. Eggs are laid in foodstuffs. Adults and larvae are predatory and feed on fly and beetle larvae, and mites.



HOLOLEPTA SP.
Commonly called flat hister beetles, the species in this genus have a very flat and hard body surface. They live under the bark of fallen trees.

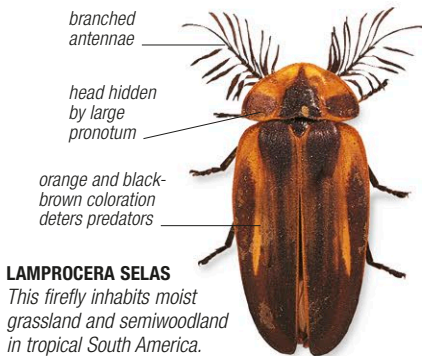
Family Lampyridae

Fireflies

Occurrence 2,000 spp. worldwide; on vegetation in woodland and moist grassland, in soil, under stones



Also known as lightning-bugs, many fireflies use species-specific flashes of cold green light made by luminous organs on their abdomen in order to attract mates. The females of some species even imitate the flashing of closely related species to lure males and eat them. Fireflies are $\frac{3}{16}$ – $1\frac{1}{4}$ in (0.5–3 cm) long. Males are usually fully winged, whereas some females are wingless and may resemble larvae. The larvae eat a small range of snails and other invertebrates. Most adults feed on nectar or dew, although some are predatory.



LAMPROCERA SELAS
This firefly inhabits moist grassland and semiwoodland in tropical South America.